an attacker? It was all very theoretical, but for some reason, the Cdr thought I was 'leaking' the plans and forbade me from speaking either to the CO or any of the unit officers.

I tried to explain to him that I was just being an unbiased instructor and that the officers of the other unit were equally free to attend but to no avail. I also pointed out that if I really wished to compromise the exercise, I could just as easily speak to the CO after we had broken off for the day and returned to our rooms, and that he was, in fact, doubting my very integrity. I don't think he liked that very much, but since he was adamant, I asked to be excused from the Control. The war game continued as scheduled, the outcome being more to test the software program and glitches rather than any tactical outcome. It was not a win-lose kind of a war game to see who was more competent professionally but was aimed more at testing the software. Anyway, we all returned to the unit and I forgot all about this incident.

While at Meerut, I was nominated to attend the Senior Command (SC) course at the AWC, Mhow. Unlike the JC course, which is mandatory for all officers, the SC course is by nomination, based on merit. Getting nominated for the SC course means one is on the right track for the next rank. Because of the ongoing school term, Veena and the girls could not accompany me to Mhow, so once again, three months of the peace tenure were spent away from each other. I did well on this course too, getting another instructional grading, which further enhanced my professional reputation. At about the same time, the results of the selection board (SB 4) from Maj to Lt Col were declared and I had made the grade.[3] While I was away on SC, Vivek, now a Lt Col had rejoined the unit and taken over as the 2iC. Since the authorization prevailing at that time allowed for only one Lt Col in the unit, it meant that I would once again

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